Historical source

Encyclopaedia Britannica scan, source row 1415. Parse 3.5 extracted the text. Super 3.5 VL corrected it from an enlarged crop of each block. It can still contain recognition errors. Page headers, footers, and page numbers are removed.

Untitled continuation (E0118)

Continues an entry from an earlier page.

make a very beautiful appearance. The whole plant is full of a very acrid and caustic milk. 7. Rack is a large tree, growing not only in Abyssinia but in many places of Arabia Felix. Its wood is so hard and bitter, that no worm will touch it; for which reason it is used by the Arabs for constructing their boats. It grows, like the mangrove, among the salt-water of the sea, or about salt springs. 8. Gir-gir, or gefe-el-aube; a kind of grass found about Ras-el-Feel, growing to the height of about three feet four inches. 9. The kantufa, a very noxious species of thorn, much more troublesome than any with which we are acquainted, and growing to the height of eight or more feet. The flowers have a long fennel like the flower mignionet. 10. The gaguedi, is a short tree only about nine feet high, a native of Lamalmon. The flowers, which are yellow and very beautiful, turn towards the sun like those of the heliantthus. 11. The wancey, a tree common throughout all Abyssinia; flowers exactly on the first day the rains cease. It grows to the height of 18 or 20 feet; having a thick bark and clove heavy wood; the first part of which is white, but the rest of a dark colour. The flowers are of a beautiful white colour; but it does not appear to possess any other remarkable property, though it is held in great estimation by the Abyssinians, and is even worshipped by the Galla. 12. The farek, or Bauhinia acuminata, grows in the country immediately adjacent to the sources of the Nile; being found by Mr Bruce scarce 400 yards distant from the fountain. 13. Kuara, is a beautiful tree, growing in the fourth and fourth-west parts of Abyssinia. It has a fruit like a bean, of a red colour, which in the early ages was made use of as a weight for gold and diamonds; and hence Mr Bruce is of opinion that the name of the imaginary weight carat is derived. 14. The walkuffa, grows in the hottest parts of Ethiopia. It is a flowering tree, with beautiful white blossoms, which do not appear till towards the middle of January. The flowers have no smell, and are accounted pernicious to bees. The wood is very heavy. 15. The wooginoos, or Brucea antidysenterica, is common throughout the whole empire, but principally on the sides of the valleys. It is a favourite remedy against the dysentery, a very common and fatal disease in hot countries. Mr Bruce had experimental proof of its antidysenteric virtues. 16. Cufo, or Bankia anthelmintica, is a very beautiful and useful tree, being a strong anthelmintic, and used as such by the Abyssinians. Every person there, whether male or female, is troubled with that kind of worm called ascarides; a great number of which are evacuated every month, and the evacuation is promoted by an infusion of this plant. While taking this medicine, the patients frequently seclude themselves from all their acquaintance, and keep close at home. It is said, that the want of this medicine in other countries is the reason why the Abyssinians do not go out of their own country; or, if they do, that they are short-lived. 17. Teff, is a kind of grain found generally through Abyssinia; and constituting the bread commonly made use of by the inhabitants. They have indeed plenty of wheat, and are as skilful in forming it into bread as the Europeans; but this is only made use of by people of the first rank; however, the teff is sometimes of such an excellent quality, that the bread made from it is held in equal estimation with the finest wheat. From the bread made of this

grain a fourrifi liquor called _loza_ is prepared, which Echiopia is used for common drink like our final beer. A li- queor of the fine kind, but of inferior quality, is made from barley cakes. Some have been of opinion, that the uife of tress occations the worms above mentioned; but this is converted by Mr Brune. Nock, a plant not to be diliguated from the margard either in hape, fizaz, or foliage, is alto sown very generally over the country, and families all Abyffinia with oil for the kitchen and other after use.

Abyssinia abounds with a vast variety of quadrupeds both wild and tame. Immense numbers of cattle every where present themselves, some of them the most beautiful in the world. Some have monstrous horns, said to be capable of holding 10 quarts each; but this, as our author informs us, is a defect which proves fatal to them. Buffalos are here met with in great numbers, and are very fierce and untractable; but there are no such animals as carnivorous bulls, which have been said to exist in this and other internal parts of Africa. Antelopes and other wild animals are met with in great numbers in the uncultivated parts; feeding chiefly on the leaves of trees. They abound most of all, however, in those parts which have been once cultivated, but since defoliated by the calamities of war; and where wild oats abound in such quantities as to hide them from pursuit. Hyenas, lions, foxes, jackals, wild boars, &c. are also found, as well as the elephant, rhinoceros, camelopard, and others of the larger and more uncommon kinds. Great havock is made in the cultivated fields by multitudes of baboons, apes, rats, and mice. There is plenty of hares; but these being reckoned unclean, as well as wild boars, are not used as food. The rivers abound with crocodiles and hippopotami, at least the Nile, and those large streams which flow into it; but a great

number have water in them only during the rainy season, and they have neither fish nor any animal that feeds upon them.

The number of birds in this country is immense; nor are those of the carnivorous kind at all deficient. Great numbers of eagles, vultures, hawks, and others of that kind, are met with, and come punctually every year after the tropical rains have ceased. They feed at first upon the hell-fish which are met with in great quantities on the edges of the deserts, where they had lived in the salt springs; but, being forced from their natural habitations when the springs were swelled by the rains, are afterwards left to perish on dry land. When these fail, their next resource is from the carcases of the large animals, such as the elephant and rhinoceros, which are killed in the flat country by the hunters. Their next supply is the multitude of rats and field-mice which infest the country after harvest. The vast slaughter of cattle made by the Abyssinian armies, the multitude of persons killed, whose bodies are allowed to rot on the field of battle, &c. furnish them also with another resource. These supplies, however, all fail at the beginning of the rainy season, when the hunters and armies return home, and the vast quantity of water which continually overflows the ground renders it impossible for them to find any other food.

There are other birds which feed upon insects, and multitudes which live on grain or seeds of various kinds; all of which are amply supplied by the immense quantity of fruits and berries which grow in Abyssinia, and are ripe at all seasons of the year. A very re-

markable:

Source record

Scan ID `britannica:309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443:train:1415`

Image file `page-1415-d28d11d04726.jpg`

Image SHA-256 `d28d11d047269c4378e2a038829a2e80312fca36533bc35728f3c45768d0fb89`

Dataset NationalLibraryOfScotland/encyclopaedia_britannica_illustrated at revision `309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443` (CC0-1.0)

Extraction model `nvidia/nemotron-3.5-parse`, raw reply `extract/raw/page-1415-d28d11d04726.json`

Raw reply SHA-256 `41453ec35b8cd4750ed524cbf1720341c9174763a4d6cb70a76dfb2ed5cc7147`

Correction model `nvidia/Nemotron-3.5-Super-VL`, block crops, raw replies `correct/raw/crop_nothink/page-1415-d28d11d04726-b*.json`; super_vl: 6

Running header ET H [797] E T H